

Word family: **around**

Base word: around

Useful expressions / extensions: around here, around the world, around the corner, around the time, around + number, all around, turn around, come around, get around, be around

Part of speech: adverb (副詞) / preposition (介詞)

Your sentence:

> “Overall, I like her not just because she is family, but because being **around** her reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **around** appears in:

> **be around someone**

and means:

> **to be physically near someone or spend time in that person's company**

The speaker means that simply **being with / spending time near the grandmother** has an emotional effect.

繁體中文： ** **在某人身邊；與某人相處；處於某人的陪伴之中

**中文翻譯： **

> “Being around her reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

「**和她相處 / 待在她身邊**，會提醒我，善良可以很安靜、穩定，卻非常有力量。」

Here:

being around her = 和她在一起、待在她身邊、與她相處

1. **be around someone (在某人身邊 / 與某人相處) — 和.....相處；待在.....身邊**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Being **around her** reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

「**和她相處 / 待在她身邊**，會提醒我善良可以很安靜、穩定，卻非常有力量。」

Practice 2

> “I feel relaxed when I’m **around her**.”

「我**和她相處時**會感到很放鬆。」

Practice 3

> “Children enjoy being **around** him.”

「孩子們很喜歡**和他相處 / 待在他身邊**。」

be around someone = 與某人在同一地方、處於其陪伴之中，通常帶有「相處」的意思

2. **around = surrounding / on every side (在……周圍) — 在周圍；圍繞著**

A core spatial meaning.

Practice 4

> “There were trees **around** the house.”

「房子**周圍**有很多樹。」

Practice 5

> “Everyone gathered **around** the table.”

「大家都聚集在桌子**周圍**。」

around = 位於某人 / 某物四周或附近的位置

3. **around = moving in a circle / surrounding path (繞著) — 繞著；沿……四周**

Practice 6

> “We walked **around** the lake.”

「我們**繞著湖**散步。」

Practice 7

> “The Earth moves **around** the Sun.”

「地球**繞著太陽**運行。」

around = 沿著某物外圍移動，或沿近似圓形路線移動

4. **around** = from place to place within an area (到處) — 四處；到處

Practice 8

> “We walked **around** for an hour.”

「我們**四處**走了**一小時**。」

Practice 9

> “She looked **around** the room.”

「她**環顧房間四周**。」

around = 在某個範圍內由一處移動到另一處，而不是向單一方向前進

5. **look around** (四處看看) — 環顧；四處看看

A very common construction.

Practice 10

> “She **looked around** before sitting down.”

「她坐下前**先環顧四周**。」

Practice 11

> “Let’s **look around** the market.”

「我們在市場裡**四處看看**吧。」

look around = 朝不同方向看，或在某個地方四處查看

6. **around here / around there (這附近 / 那附近) — 附近；一帶**

Practice 12

> “Is there a café **around here**?”

「**這附近**有咖啡店嗎？」

Practice 13

> “She lives somewhere **around there**.”

「她住在**那一帶附近**。」

around here/there = 在說話者指出的位置附近，而不是某個精確地點

7. **around = nearby / in the area (在附近) — 在附近；在場**

Practice 14

> “Is your manager **around**?”

「你經理**在附近 / 在嗎**？」

Practice 15

> “There wasn’t anyone **around**.”

「附近**沒有人**。」

around = 在附近、在場或可接觸到

8. **be around = be present / available (在場 / 可找到) — 在；在附近**

Practice 16

> “I’ll be **around** all afternoon.”

「我整個下午都會**在這附近 / 在這裡**。」

Practice 17

> “Will you be **around** tomorrow?”

「你明天會**在嗎 / 在附近嗎**？」

be around = 在某個地方出現、停留或可以找到

9. **be around** = exist for some time (存在) — 存在；已存在

A useful figurative extension.

Practice 18

> “That company has been **around** for decades.”

「那間公司已經**存在了幾十年**。」

Practice 19

> “This idea has been **around** for a long time.”

「這個想法已經**存在很久**。」

be around = 某人 / 某物仍存在，或已經存在一段時間

10. **around** + number = approximately (大約) — 大約；左右

A major meaning.

Practice 20

> “There were **around** fifty people.”

「大約有**五十人左右**。」

Practice 21

> “The journey takes **around** two hours.”

「旅程大約需要**兩小時左右**。」

****around + number = 數量、時間、距離等並非精確數字，而是大約值****

11. ****around + time (大約某個時間) — 大約在.....****

Practice 22

> “I’ll arrive ****around**** six.”

「我會****大約六點****到。」

Practice 23

> “She usually calls ****around**** lunchtime.”

「她通常在****午飯時間左右****打電話。」

****around + time = 在某個時間點前後不久****

12. ****around = approximately in general (大概) — 大約；差不多****

Practice 24

> “It costs ****around**** \$100.”

「大約要****100 元左右****。」

Practice 25

> “She is ****around**** seventy years old.”

「她大約****七十歲左右****。」

****around = 表示估算，而非精確數值****

Close to:

> about / approximately

13. ****around the world (世界各地) — 世界各地；環遊世界****

Two closely related uses.

Practice 26

> “The news spread **around the world**.”

「消息傳遍了**世界各地**。」

Practice 27

> “They travelled **around the world**.”

「他們**環遊世界**。」

around the world = 在世界很多地方 / 沿著世界不同地區移動

Context determines whether it means distribution or travel.

14. **all around** (四周 ; 到處) — 四周 ; 到處

Practice 28

> “There were flowers **all around**.”

「**四周到處**都是花。」

Practice 29

> “We could hear birds **all around** us.”

「我們可以聽到**四周**都有鳥叫聲。」

all around = 在各個方向、四面八方

15. **around the corner** — 在轉角處

Literal spatial meaning.

Practice 30

> “The shop is just **around the corner**.”

「那間店就在**轉角附近**。」

Practice 31

> “There’s a bus stop **around the corner**.”

「**轉角處**有個巴士站。」

around the corner = 在下一個街角 / 轉彎處附近

16. **around the corner = coming very soon (很快到來) — 即將來臨**

A common figurative extension.

Practice 32

> “Summer is just **around the corner**.”

「夏天**很快就到了**。」

Practice 33

> “The exam is **around the corner**.”

「考試**快到了**。」

around the corner = 某件事情即將發生 / 時間上非常接近

17. **around the time of... (在.....前後) — 大約在.....時候**

Practice 34

> “I met her **around the time of** graduation.”

「我大約在**畢業前後**認識她。」

Practice 35

> “The change happened **around the time** she moved.”

「那個變化大約發生在她搬屋**前後那段時間**。」

****around the time of X = 在某個事件發生的前後一段時間****

18. ****around someone/something = concerning / centred on (圍繞某議題) — 圍繞 ; 以.....為中心****

A common abstract extension.

Practice 36

> “The discussion centred ****around**** education.”

「討論****圍繞教育問題****展開。」

Practice 37

> “Much of her life revolves ****around**** her family.”

「她生活中很大一部分都****圍繞著家庭****。」

****around = 某個活動、討論或生活安排以某主題 / 人物為中心****

Note: ****centre around**** is common, although some formal editors prefer ****centre on****.

19. ****around = available / circulating (流通 / 可見) — 流傳著 ; 存在著****

Practice 38

> “There are several versions of the story ****around****.”

「這個故事目前****流傳著幾個版本****。」

Practice 39

> “There’s a lot of misinformation ****around****.”

「現在****流傳著很多錯誤資訊****。」

****around = 某些資訊、想法或事物正在社會中存在 / 流傳****

20. **turn around (轉身 / 轉向) — 轉過身 ; 掉頭**

A highly common phrasal extension.

Practice 40

> “She **turned around** and smiled.”

「她**轉過身**笑了。」

Practice 41

> “The driver **turned the car around**.”

「司機把車**掉頭**。」

turn around = 改變面向或行進方向，使其朝相反方向

21. **turn around = improve/reverse a bad situation (扭轉) — 扭轉局面**

Practice 42

> “The company managed to **turn around** its business.”

「公司成功**扭轉業務困境**。」

Practice 43

> “Her attitude completely **turned around**.”

「她的態度完全**轉變了**。」

turn around = 使情況、表現或態度出現明顯逆轉

This is a figurative extension from physical turning.

22. **come around = visit (過來 / 來訪) — 過來 ; 來訪**

Practice 44

> “Why don’t you **come around** this afternoon?”

「你今天下午不如**過來坐坐**？」

Practice 45

> “She often **comes around** on Sundays.”

「她星期日經常**過來探望**。」

come around = 到某人家 / 某地探訪；非正式

23. **come around = change opinion (改變看法) — 改變想法；被說服**

Practice 46

> “He eventually **came around** to my point of view.”

「他最後**改變看法，接受了我的觀點**。」

Practice 47

> “Give her time—she may **come around**.”

「給她一點時間，她可能會**改變主意**。」

come around = 經過一段時間後改變原先態度，開始接受另一種看法

24. **come around = regain consciousness (恢復知覺) — 醒過來；恢復意識**

Practice 48

> “She fainted but soon **came around**.”

「她暈倒了，但很快就**恢復意識**。」

Practice 49

> “He slowly **came around** after the operation.”

「手術後，他慢慢**恢復了知覺**。」

come around = 從昏迷、暈倒或失去意識中恢復清醒

25. **get around = travel/move from place to place (四處走動) — 到處走；出行**

Practice 50

> “It’s easy to **get around** the city by train.”

「乘火車在城內**四處出行**很方便。」

Practice 51

> “She has difficulty **getting around** these days.”

「她現在**四處走動**有點困難。」

get around = 在某個地方移動 / 往來

26. **get around = avoid a rule/problem (繞過) — 規避；避開**

Practice 52

> “They found a way to **get around** the rule.”

「他們找到方法**規避那條規則**。」

Practice 53

> “There’s no easy way to **get around** this problem.”

「沒有簡單方法可以**避開這個問題**。」

get around something = 找方法避開限制、規則或障礙

27. **get around = spread / become known (傳開) — 傳開；流傳**

Practice 54

> “News **gets around** quickly.”

「消息很快就會**傳開**。」

Practice 55

> “Word soon **got around** that she was leaving.”

「她要離開的消息很快就**傳開了**。」

get around = 資訊在人與人之間迅速傳播

Important distinction: **around** vs **near**

near

means:

> close to a particular point.

> “She lives near the school.”

around

can mean:

> in the surrounding area, without giving an exact position.

> “She lives around here.”

So **around** is often less precise.

Important distinction: **around** vs **about** — approximation

For numbers and time, they often overlap:

> **around 50 people**

> **about 50 people**

Both:

= 大約五十人。

Around is very natural in conversation.

Important distinction: **around** vs **approximately**

around

more conversational:

> “around ten minutes”

approximately

more formal:

> “approximately ten minutes”

Both mean:

> 大約

Important distinction: **around** vs **round**

In many British-English contexts, **round** and **around** overlap:

> walk around the park

> walk round the park

> come around

> come round

American English generally prefers **around** in many of these uses.

However, they are not interchangeable in every fixed expression.

Important distinction: **be around someone** vs **be with someone**

be with someone

simply means:

> be together / accompany them.

be around someone

often carries a broader sense of:

> spending time in their presence or being in their environment.

Your passage:

> “being around her”

sounds natural because it emphasizes the **effect of her presence**.

Important distinction: **around someone vs **near someone****

**near someone**

= physically close.

**around someone**

can mean:

> frequently in their company / spending time with them.

So:

> “I like being around her.”

means more than:

> “I like standing near her.”

It means:

> “I enjoy being in her company.”

Important distinction: **be around vs **stay around****

**be around**

= be present/available.

**stay around**

= remain in the area instead of leaving.

> “I’ll be around.”

= 我會在附近 / 會在。

> “Stay around for a while.”

= 留在附近一會兒。

Important distinction: **around** = surrounding vs through

around the city

can mean:

> different places throughout the city.

through the city

often emphasizes:

> movement from one side/part to another through its interior.

The spatial image differs.

Important distinction: **around** = around a perimeter vs across

walk around the lake

= 沿湖的外圍走。

walk across the lake

= 穿過湖面 / 從一邊到另一邊 (如果可能) 。

So **around** avoids crossing the centre.

Important distinction: **around the corner** — literal vs figurative

Literal:

> “The café is around the corner.”

= 咖啡店在轉角處。

Figurative:

> “Winter is around the corner.”

= 冬天快到了。

The figurative sense maps:

> physical closeness → temporal closeness.

Important distinction: **be around = present vs exist**

Present:

> “Is John around?”

= John 在嗎 / 在附近嗎？

Exist:

> “That idea has been around for years.”

= 那個想法存在多年了。

Same expression, but the time-scale and meaning differ.

Important distinction: **around + number vs exactly**

around 30

= 大約三十

exactly 30

= 正正三十

So **around** explicitly signals approximation.

Important distinction: around someone — your sentence vs spatial around

Compare:

> “There were people around her.”

= 她周圍有人。

versus:

> “I like being around her.”

= 我喜歡和她相處。

The first is primarily spatial.

The second is social/interpersonal.

Important distinction: around vs throughout

around the world

= 世界各地

throughout the world

= 遍及全世界

They overlap, but **throughout** more strongly emphasizes extensive distribution across the whole area.

Important distinction: turn around vs go around

turn around

= change direction.

go around

can mean:

- * move around something
- * circulate
- * visit various places

> “Go around the building.”

= 繞過 / 繞著建築物走。

Family-extension note

Around is a very good example of a high-frequency word whose meanings grow from several strong conceptual cores:

- * **surrounding position** → around the house
- * **circular/peripheral movement** → walk around the lake
- * **movement within an area** → walk around
- * **nearby presence** → is she around?
- * **social proximity/company** → being around her
- * **approximation** → around fifty
- * **temporal proximity** → around six / around the corner
- * **continued existence/circulation** → the idea has been around
- * **abstract centring** → discussion around an issue

The highly common phrasal forms **turn around, come around, get around** add further lexicalized branches, but they should remain clearly labelled as phrasal extensions rather than being presented as additional bare-word meanings.

That matches the manual's requirement to scan grammar constructions and useful fixed expressions widely while still keeping the core semantic structure conservative.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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be around someone	與某人在同一環境中相處、待在某人身邊或享受其陪伴
around — surrounding position	位於某人 / 某物的四周或附近
around — circular movement	沿某物外圍或近似圓形的路線移動

around — movement within an area	在某個範圍內由一處移動到另一處；四處	
look around	朝不同方向看或在某處四處查看	
around here/there	某個位置附近或一帶	
be around — present	在附近、在場或可以找到	
be around — exist	某人 / 某物存在或已存在一段時間	
around + number	表示數量、時間、距離等只是大約值	
around + time	在某個時間點前後不久	
around the world	世界各地 / 在世界不同地方之間移動	
all around	在各個方向；四面八方	
around the corner — literal	位於下一個街角 / 轉角附近	
around the corner — figurative	某件事情很快就會發生	
around the time of X	在某事件發生前後的一段時間	
around — centred on	某活動 / 討論 / 安排以某主題或人物為中心	
around — circulating/existing	某些資訊、想法或事物正在流傳 / 存在	
turn around — physical	改變面向或行進方向	
turn around — figurative	使壞情況、表現或態度出現明顯逆轉	
come around — visit	過來某人家 / 某地探訪	
come around — opinion	經過一段時間後改變原有看法	
come around — consciousness	從暈倒 / 失去意識中恢復清醒	
get around — movement	在某個地方四處移動 / 出行	
get around — avoid	找方法規避規則、限制或障礙	
get around — spread	消息或資訊在人與人之間傳開	

For your original sentence

> “Overall, I like her not just because she is family, but because being **around her** reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

The exact meaning is:

****be around someone = 和某人相處、待在某人身邊、處於某人的陪伴之中****

Therefore:

> ****being around her****

= ****「和外婆相處 / 待在她身邊」****

This is more than simple physical distance.

It does ****not**** merely mean:

> “I am physically near her.”

Rather, it suggests:

- > spending time with her
- > experiencing her personality
- > being influenced by her presence

So the most natural Traditional Chinese rendering here is:

- > **「和她相處」**

rather than the overly literal:

- > **「在她周圍」**

And that contextual distinction is exactly the kind of meaning discrimination this polysemy project is designed to capture.